

PG INNOVATION GOVERNANCE

How we got to a recommended model, and what SBTDWS can offer · Tuesday 2026-08-18

OFFERED FOR THE CHAIR'S USE — TAKE IT OR LEAVE IT

Everyone in the room will want to own the idea. Almost no one will want to own the work — and whoever grabs a piece is likely to run it alone, without inviting the others in. Worth saying explicitly before the working group settles into its routine. This brief sets out the thinking that led to the current model, so it doesn't need re-deriving from scratch in the room.

WHO DOES WHAT

CDD / J8	Runs PG capability dev & R&D today, has for some time. Confirmed lead of this Working Group.	CONFIRMED LEAD
STC	Former S&T Center, now folded into CDD.	FUNCTION STILL UNCLEAR TO SOME
FALCONS BDE	MAKHLAB 1 sits in this WG as a separate project — Falcons Bde is the framework/best-practice reference as other units build their own MAKHLAB serials.	IN WG, SEPARATE PROJECT
SBTDWS	Tactical experimentation execution — Tier 1, EXCON, evaluation, via the standing TEIW charter.	CALIBRATED OFFER

THE TIERS — IDEA TO CAPABILITY

01 IDEA SOURCE Any operator, any unit	02 INTAKE & SPONSORSHIP No mechanism exists today	03 TIER 1 EXPERIMENT Bounded, 30–90 days	04 TIER 2 GATE Capital/scale — now CDD's lane
05 SCALE & FIELD Fielding, small-run, handover	06 STANDARDISE Cross-unit, once >1 runs it	07 INSTITUTIONALISE Doctrine, training, FDC review	

Explaining these tiers is the point of this brief. Stage 3 (Tier 1) is where SBTDWS's TEIW charter already operates — offered below as a ready-made, PG-wide template. Stage 4 (Tier 2) is the gate CDD now chairs. Stage 2 (intake) still has no owner or mechanism, regardless of who chairs the gate.

"WHO LEADS" IS THREE QUESTIONS

1 PORTFOLIO GOVERNANCE Priorities, resourcing. Tier 2 kill/continue, deconfliction. This is what CDD now chairs.	2 EXECUTION Running the sprints. Stays distributed at unit/school level — this is where TEIW sits.	3 SPONSORSHIP Naming problems, providing operators, validating outputs. Unit-level.
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STILL WORTH FLAGGING IN THE ROOM

ACT · SHAPE

ACT	Now that CDD chairs, the separation from day-to-day CAPDEV procurement/fielding matters more, not less — worth landing explicitly, not assuming it's understood.
ACT	Stage 2 (intake) still has no owner or mechanism — a live gap regardless of who chairs governance.
SHAPE	A department running CAPDEV well today isn't automatically suited to running innovation — different culture, and possibly not yet the institutional weight to make a ring-fenced cell stick.
SHAPE	No budget/bridge-funding mechanism exists yet between a proven experiment and a resourced programme.

GOVERNANCE-CHAIR OPTIONS — FOR CONTEXT

A IS THE DECIDED MODEL

OPTION	STRENGTH	RISK
A — CDD leads (decided)	Already does this work today; no new stand-up.	Process-first culture; may need an explicit authority uplift, not just organisational ring-fencing, to make separation from CAPDEV stick.
B — J3 leads	De facto owner on paper; fewest new seams.	Concentration — already carries readiness, targeting, C2.
C — New entity	Matches outside pattern; a distinct engine.	Slowest — charter, staffing, competes for bandwidth with other PG 2030 decisions.
Synthesis, still worth keeping in view	A standing board rather than one department doing everything: CDD chairs for mandate-setting, its former-S&T scouting function held distinct from its CAPDEV/procurement arm, unit reps (SBTDWS, Falcons Bde, and every unit with a MAKHLAB serial) provide demand signal and run execution.	

WHAT SBTDWS OFFERS

CALIBRATED, NOT A GOVERNANCE CLAIM

- A working Tier 1 experiment template — hypothesis, MOE, bounded entry criteria, already running under Commandant authority — offered as the PG-wide Stage 3 pattern, not just an SBTDWS-internal tool.
- A natural physical and organisational home for that template as the Multi-Domain Training Center stands up at Hameem — SBTDWS proposes co-locating TEIW's experiment function there rather than building it twice.
- A manufacturing/prototyping idea, raised as exactly that — an idea. Genuinely contested: there's a real case that UAE industry should build this instead of the PG holding it internally.